

Choosing Simplicity

The perks of simplification are endless. At its core, simplifying aims at maximizing the things that are valuable and minimizing the things that are wasteful. When applied to all areas of our lives, we can experience less stress, greater efficiency, and more of what we enjoy.

The trouble is, despite the knowledge of these benefits, we can be drawn to complexity instead. And without systems of maintenance in place, the whole thing can become expensive, complicated, or chaotic.

For example, take when my husband, Eric, and I (Jill) were living in our RV. As part of the full-time RVer world, we learned that there's quite the spectrum of approaches to the lifestyle! We lived in a motorhome to reduce our living expenses, but others did it to explore the country comfortably. They had brand-new motor coaches with king-sized beds, quartz countertops, multiple bathrooms, and full outdoor kitchens that pulled out from the side. All on wheels! For us, it cost very little, but for others, this same lifestyle was a multi-million-dollar endeavor. We had friends and acquaintances interested in the lifestyle, for both money-saving and adventure-seeking reasons, who asked us about building out vans and buses. Our common response became "There's a way to do it complicated and expensive, and there's a way to do it simply and inexpensive." And this is true for nearly every category of life. We can make our schedules, relationships, environments, and finances complicated or simple.

Now when we say simple, we don't mean plain or boring. We're not advocating for minimalism or stoicism for the sake of simplicity. We want you to think of simplifying as taking an intentional subtractive approach instead of the automated additive solutions we're used to.

Simplifying isn't always the right answer—sometimes rearranging or reprioritizing is—but it's hard to see what the answer is in the clutter of complexity we've built around our lives. So, in order to get a grasp on our external environment, here are three places we can start simplifying:

Our physical spaces, schedules, and routines.